

Cartivo Merchant — User Manual

How to set the app up on a phone or tablet and work every screen, step by step.

Written for

Merchant Staff, Store Owners & Front-of-House Operators

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NOTE This is a non-technical guide. It assumes the Cartivo Merchant app is already installed on the device. If it still needs installing or configuring, hand your IT person the *Cartivo Merchant — Technical Manual* first.

1. About Cartivo Merchant

Cartivo Merchant (shown on the device as **Cartivo Merchant**, and titled **DPO Merchant** in some builds) is a companion app for third-party merchants who sell through the Cartivo / DPO platform. Its one job is to put every online order for your store in front of your staff the moment it is placed, and to let them move that order through to completion.

What the app does

- **Shows your live order feed.** New orders from your storefront appear on the screen within a second, with a sound / banner alert.
- **Lets you work each order.** Move an order from *Pending* to *Preparing* to *Ready to Fulfilled*, or cancel it.
- **Keeps a local copy.** The orders you have already received are stored on the device, so the list still opens when the connection drops — you just can't receive new ones until it comes back.
- **Alerts you in the background.** A phone notification fires for every new or changed order even when the app is not the screen you are looking at.

What the app does NOT do

- It is **not** a point-of-sale / cash register. It does not ring up walk-in sales, take payment, or print receipts.
- It has **no product catalogue, no inventory, and no reports.** Those live in the main Cartivo POS.
- It has **no user accounts or PINs.** Anyone holding the unlocked device can work the order list. Treat the device accordingly.

The one thing to understand: this app needs the internet

Unlike the full Cartivo POS, this app does almost nothing offline. The live feed, order updates, and first-time setup all need a working Wi-Fi or mobile-data connection. Offline, you can only *read* the orders already downloaded.

IMPORTANT Keep the device on a stable connection during trading hours. The app reconnects on its own after a brief drop, but a long outage means missed orders.

2. Before you start

What you need

- An **Android phone or tablet** (Android 8 / 2017 or newer recommended; the app targets modern Android). iPhone / iPad is not supported.
- The **Cartivo Merchant app** installed. Your IT person or provider builds and installs it — see the Technical Manual.
- A **Wi-Fi or mobile-data** connection.
- Your **Merchant ID** and **Merchant Name**, as issued by your Cartivo / DPO provider. If you were not given a Merchant ID, the app can generate one for you to hand back to your provider.
- Someone on the **merchant administrator** side who can approve this device (see “Getting your device approved”).

How the app is laid out

There is only one screen: the **dashboard**. Everything happens there — a thin toolbar across the top, and the order list filling the rest. Setup prompts appear as pop-up dialogs over that screen.

Area	What it is
Top-left	The Cartivo wordmark, and — once you are set up — your <i>Merchant Name</i> <i>Merchant ID</i> underneath it.
Top-right	The device-status icon (only while not yet approved), the live-connection pill, and the Settings gear.
Below the toolbar	The Orders heading, a Refresh link, and a row of filter tabs (<i>All</i> , plus one per status).
Main area	The list of order cards, newest first. Pull down to refresh.

3. First-time setup — registering your merchant

The very first time the app opens with no merchant saved, it puts a **Register Merchant** dialog on screen that you cannot dismiss until it is filled in. This happens once per device.

- 1 Open the app. The **Register Merchant** dialog appears.
- 2 Check the **Merchant ID** field. The app has pre-filled a random 10-character ID. If your provider gave you an ID, delete the pre-filled one and type theirs exactly. If not, keep the generated one and pass it to your provider so they can register your store on their side.
- 3 Type your **Merchant Name** — your store's name as you want it to read (for example *Juan's Store*).
- 4 Tap **Register**. The button shows a spinner while the app talks to the server.
- 5 If the details are accepted, the dialog closes and the app moves straight to checking whether this device is approved (next section).
- 6 If you see a red error message instead, read it, fix the field it points to (usually a wrong Merchant ID or no connection), and tap **Register** again.

IMPORTANT The Merchant ID and Name you enter here are also what your provider sees. They must match what the provider has on file, or orders will never reach this device.

What “registering” actually does

Two things happen behind that one **Register** tap:

- The app asks the server for a security token tied to your Merchant ID.
- The app then **enrols this physical device** under your merchant account, sending a fingerprint of the device (its model, Android version, and a permanent install ID). The device starts life *pending* — it is not yet allowed to receive orders.

4. Getting your device approved

A newly registered device is **Pending**. It can open the app and show past orders, but the live feed stays switched off until a merchant administrator approves it from their side. You cannot approve your own device.

The three device states

State	Icon in toolbar	What it means
Pending	Amber hourglass	Submitted, waiting for the administrator. Live orders are off. You may keep using the app.
Approved	(icon disappears)	The device is cleared. Live orders turn on automatically — no restart needed.
Deactivated	Red block / no-entry	The administrator has turned this device's access off. Live orders are paused. Contact your administrator to restore it.

While you wait

- 1 A **Device Pending Approval** dialog explains the status. Tap **Got it** to dismiss it — you can keep the app open.
- 2 Ask your merchant administrator to approve the device (they do this in their own Cartivo admin tools).
- 3 You do **not** need to do anything else. The app quietly re-checks every 15 seconds, and again each time you bring it back to the foreground. The moment approval lands, the amber icon vanishes, a green “**Device approved — you're all set**” banner appears, and the connection pill turns to **Live**.

Checking manually

If you don't want to wait for the automatic check:

- Tap the **amber hourglass icon** in the toolbar, then tap **Check again** in the dialog. The button spins while it re-checks and reports the fresh result.
- Or open **Settings** (the gear) — the card at the top of that screen shows the current device status and has its own **Check status** button.

NOTE If the dialog shows a note from your administrator (a “review note”), read it — it usually says what they still need from you before approving.

5. The dashboard toolbar

The strip across the top of the screen is always visible. Here is every control on it, left to right.

Control	What it does
Cartivo wordmark + store line	Identifies the app and, underneath, shows <i>your Merchant Name</i> <i>your Merchant ID</i> once set up. Read-only.
Device-status icon (amber hourglass or red block)	Only shown while the device is <i>not</i> approved. Tap it to re-open the status dialog and re-check.
Connection pill	The state of the live order feed. See the table below. On a narrow phone screen it shrinks to just a coloured dot.
Settings gear	Opens Merchant Settings — edit your store name / ID and see the device-status card.

Reading the connection pill

Pill	Colour	Meaning
Live	Green	Connected. New orders will arrive instantly.
Connecting	Amber (pulsing)	Establishing the connection — normal for a few seconds after opening the app.
Reconnecting	Amber (pulsing)	The connection dropped and the app is retrying. It backs off gradually and keeps trying — usually recovers on its own.
Offline	Grey	Not connected and not trying — because there is no merchant set up, the device isn't approved, or it was deactivated.

NOTE A short spell of **RECONNECTING** is nothing to worry about — the app replays any orders you missed as soon as it is back. If it stays on **RECONNECTING** for minutes, check the device's internet.

6. The Orders list

The main area is the order list — one card per order, most recent at the top. It updates itself as orders arrive and change.

The filter tabs

- **All** is selected by default and shows every order.
- Extra tabs appear automatically, one for each status that currently has orders — *Pending*, *Preparing*, *Ready*, *Fulfilled*, *Cancelled*. Each tab shows a count.
- Tap a tab to show only that status. If a tab empties out (its last order moved on), the view falls back to **All**.

What one order card shows

- **Order #** and its **status pill** (tap the pill to change status — see the next section).
- A subtitle line: the customer name (or *Guest*), and how the order is handed over — *On-site* (with the facility name), *Pickup*, or *Delivery*.
- A relative time — *just now*, *5m ago*, *2h ago*.
- The **line items** — quantity, product name, and line price.
- The **Total**, in your storefront's currency (shown with a ₪ symbol).
- A **CANCEL ORDER** button, unless the order is already *Fulfilled* or *Cancelled*.

Refreshing the list

- The list refreshes itself on every live event. You rarely need to.
- To force a full re-fetch from the server: tap the **Refresh** link next to the *Orders* heading, or **pull down** on the list.
- If a refresh fails (no connection), a red **“Couldn't refresh — showing cached data”** banner appears with a **Retry** link. The list keeps showing the last data it had.

Empty and error states

You see	It means
“No orders yet” with a receipt icon	The current tab has no orders. Normal at the start of the day.
“Couldn't load orders” with a Try Again button	The first load failed and there was no cached copy to fall back on. Check the connection and tap Try Again .

7. Working an order — status flow

The heart of the app: moving each order through its stages so the customer and your storefront can see progress.

The stages

Status	Colour	Use it when
Pending	Amber	The order has just come in and nobody has started it. This is where new orders land.
Preparing	Amber	Someone has begun making the order.
Ready	Green	The order is finished and waiting for pickup / hand-off / the runner.
Fulfilled	Teal	The customer has received the order. This is the end state — the card locks.
Cancelled	Red	The order will not be completed. Also an end state — the card locks.

Changing the status

- 1 On the order card, tap the **status pill** (top-right of the card). It has a small down-arrow to show it is tappable.
- 2 A short menu drops down: **Pending, Preparing, Ready, Fulfilled**. The current status has a check mark.
- 3 Tap the status you want. The pill shows a spinner while it saves.
- 4 When it succeeds the pill updates and the change is pushed to your storefront. If it fails, a red message slides up from the bottom and the pill stays on the old status — try again.

NOTE You can move an order in any direction (for example back from *Ready* to *Preparing*) while it is not yet fulfilled or cancelled. Once it is **FULFILLED** or **CANCELLED** the pill is no longer tappable.

Cancelling an order

- 1 Tap the red **CANCEL ORDER** button at the bottom of the card.
- 2 A confirmation asks “**Cancel this order?**” — it warns this can't be undone.
- 3 Tap **Cancel order** to confirm, or **Keep order** to back out.
- 4 On confirm, the order moves to **Cancelled**, the card locks, and your storefront is notified.

If another device changes the same order

Orders are shared. If a colleague on another device (or your storefront) changes an order, this app receives that change on the live feed and updates the card by itself — you may see a pill change under your finger. The most recent change always wins.

8. Order details view

Tap anywhere on an order card (except the status pill or the cancel button) to slide up a full, read-only detail sheet.

What the detail sheet adds over the card

- The customer's **email address**, if the order carries one.
- The **district / delivery area name**, if present.
- Each line item with its **unit price** ("Px each") as well as the line total.
- A clear **Total** at the bottom.

- 1 Tap the card body.
- 2 The sheet rises from the bottom and covers up to ~85% of the screen. Scroll inside it if the item list is long.
- 3 Swipe it back down, or tap the dimmed area above it, to close. Nothing on this sheet can be edited — change status from the card instead.

9. Alerts and notifications

The app tells you about every new or changed order two ways at once, so nothing is missed.

Alert	When	Looks like
In-app banner	A live event arrives while you are looking at the app	A short bar slides up from the bottom, e.g. <i>"New order #1234 · 3 items · PHP 540.00"</i> . Disappears after a few seconds.
Phone notification	Any live event, foreground or background	A standard Android notification in the <i>Live orders</i> channel, with a heads-up pop and sound.

Notification messages you'll see

Event	Notification
New order	<i>New order #<id> — item count and total</i>
Order updated	<i>Order #<id> updated — "Status: <status>"</i>
Order cancelled	<i>Order #<id> cancelled</i>
Order removed	<i>Order #<id> removed</i>

Turning notifications on

- 1 The first time the app runs it asks for permission to post notifications. Tap **Allow**.
- 2 If you tapped *Don't allow* by mistake, open Android **Settings** > **Apps** > **Cartivo Merchant** > **Notifications** and switch them back on.
- 3 Keep the **Live orders** channel set to *high importance* so alerts pop up and make a sound.

NOTE Right after the app connects, it stays quiet for about 4 seconds while it catches up on the orders placed while it was closed — otherwise you'd get a burst of notifications for old orders. Only genuinely new activity alerts you.

10. Merchant Settings

Tap the **gear** in the toolbar to open **Merchant Settings**. This is where you review the device status and change your store details.

What's on the settings screen

- **Device status card** at the top — the current state (*Waiting for approval / Device approved / Device deactivated*), your merchant name, an explanation, and a **Check status** button.
- **Merchant ID** field.
- **Merchant Name** field.
- **Cancel** and **Save** buttons.

Changing your store name only

- 1 Open **Settings**, edit **Merchant Name**, tap **Save**.
- 2 A green “**Merchant settings saved**” banner confirms it. The name updates in the toolbar and on your storefront records. Your orders and device approval are untouched.

Switching to a different Merchant ID

IMPORTANT Only do this if your provider has genuinely issued you a new Merchant ID. Changing it is a full reset of the store link on this device.

- 1 Open **Settings**, replace the **Merchant ID** with the new one, adjust the name if needed, tap **Save**.
- 2 The app wipes this device's saved credentials for the old merchant and re-enrols the device under the new Merchant ID.
- 3 The device goes back to **Pending** — your administrator must approve it again under the new merchant before live orders resume.
- 4 The old merchant's orders are no longer shown.

11. When the connection drops

The app is built to ride out short outages without you doing anything. Here is exactly what happens and what you can still do.

Situation	What the app does	What you can do
Brief Wi-Fi blip	Pill shows Reconnecting , retries with growing gaps (1s, 2s, 4s... up to 30s). Reconnects and replays missed orders automatically.	Nothing. Wait for it.
Longer outage	Stays on Reconnecting . The list keeps showing the last known orders.	Read existing orders. You cannot receive new orders or reliably save status changes — a change may fail with a red message.
Airplane mode / no data at all	Pill goes to Reconnecting then effectively idle; a refresh shows the <i>cached data</i> banner.	Read cached orders only. Restore the connection to resume.
Connection returns	Reconnects within seconds, pill returns to Live , missed orders stream in (without a notification storm).	Carry on.

IMPORTANT Status changes and cancellations are **NOT QUEUED** while offline. If a change fails, it did not happen — redo it once the pill is back to **LIVE**.

12. Your daily routine

Opening up

- 1 Put the device on its stand / charger where staff can see it.
- 2 Open **Cartivo Merchant**.
- 3 Confirm the toolbar shows your store name and the pill reads **Live** (green). If it doesn't, see Troubleshooting.
- 4 Do a quick **pull-to-refresh** to be sure the list is current.

During trading

- Work new orders from the top of the **Pending** tab.
- Move each order to **Preparing** when work starts, **Ready** when it's done, **Fulfilled** when the customer has it.
- Cancel only with a real reason — it can't be undone and the customer is told.
- Glance at the pill now and then. Green = fine.

Closing down

- 1 Check the **Pending** and **Preparing** tabs are empty (or deal with what's left).
- 2 Leave the device charging and connected — there is no “sign out” and nothing to back up. The app can stay open.

13. Troubleshooting & FAQ

The pill never leaves “Connecting” or “Reconnecting”

1. Check the device is actually online — open a web page in the browser.
2. Check the device status: if the toolbar shows an amber hourglass, the device is still **Pending** — it needs administrator approval, not a connection fix.
3. If it shows a red block icon, the device is **Deactivated** — contact your administrator.
4. Pull down to refresh. If that fails too, close the app fully and re-open it.
5. Still stuck: hand the Technical Manual to your IT person — the server address in the app's configuration may be wrong or unreachable.

The pill says “Offline” and won't change

“Offline” means the app isn't even trying, which points to setup rather than the network: no merchant registered, the device not approved, or the device deactivated. Open **Settings** and read the device-status card.

I registered but no orders ever arrive

1. Confirm the **Merchant ID** in **Settings** exactly matches what your provider registered — no extra spaces, right case.
2. Confirm the device shows **Live** (approved + connected).
3. Place a test order on your storefront and watch for it.
4. If it still doesn't appear, your storefront may not be linked to this Merchant ID on the provider's side — raise it with them.

A status change failed

You'll see a red message at the bottom of the screen and the pill won't have moved. This is almost always a momentary connection problem. Wait for the pill to read **Live**, then try the change again.

I got a burst of notifications for old orders

This can happen after a long time closed or a long outage. It's harmless — the app is re-syncing. The 4-second quiet window usually suppresses it; a very large backlog can still leak a few.

Frequently asked

Question	Answer
Is there a login or PIN?	No. Whoever holds the unlocked device can use it. Lock the device itself.
Can two devices show the same store?	Yes. Register each device with the same Merchant ID and have each one approved. They stay in sync over the live feed.
Does it work on iPhone?	No — Android only.
Do I need to back anything up?	No. All order history lives on the server; the device copy is just a cache.
Can I print an order?	Not from this app. It has no printing.
What currency is the ₱ total in?	Whatever currency your storefront sends. The symbol shown is a peso sign regardless.